UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2002

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

	List I (Ancient site)		List II (Archaeological finding)
A.	Lothal	1.	Ploughed field
B.	Kalibangan	2.	Dockyard
C.	Dholavira	3.	Terracotta replica of a plough
D.	Banawali	4.	An inscription comprising ten large sized signs of the Harappan script

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	1	2	4	3
(c)	2	1	4	3
(d)	2	1	3	4

Ans. (c) : Lothal was the only Indus valley site with artificial brick dockyard. In Kalibangan evidence of ploughed agriculture fields have been found. An inscription comprising 10 large sized sign of the Harappan script was excavated from the city of Dholavira. Also a terracotta replica of plough has been discovered from Banwali.

2. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

(a) The statue of Gomateshwara at Sravanabelagola represents the last Tirthankara of Jains.

(b) India's largest Buddhist monastery is in Arunachal Pradesh.

(c) The Khajuraho temples were built under Chandela Kings.

(d) The Hoysalesvara temple is dedicated to Siva.

Ans. (a) : The statue of Gomateshwara was built by the Ganga dynasty minister and commander Chavundaraya. It is a 57-foot (17 m) monolith (statue carved from a single piece of rock) situated above a hill in Shravanabelagola in the Hassan district, Karnataka.The Gommateshwara statue is dedicated to the Jain figure Bahubali. It was built around 983 A.D. and is one of the largest free-standing statues in the world. Mahavira was the last Tirthankara of Jains.

3. In ancient Indian Buddhist monasteries, a ceremony called Pavarana used to be held, It was the

(a) Occasion to elect the Sanghaparinayka and two speakers one on Dhamma and the other on Vinaya.

(b) Confession by monks of their offences committed during their stay in the monasteries during the rainy season.

(c) Ceremony of initiation of new person into the Buddhist Sangha in which the head is shaved and when yellow robes are offered.

(d) Gathering of Buddhist monks on the next day to the full-moon day of Ashadha when they take up a fixed abode for the next four months of rainy season.

Ans. (b) : Pavarana is a Buddhist holy day celebrated on the full moon of the eleventh lunar month. It marks the end of the month of Vassa, sometimes called "Buddhist Lent." This day marks the end of the rainy season in some Asian countries like Thailand, where Theravada Buddhism is practiced. On this day, each monk must come before the community of monks and atone for an offense he may have committed during the Vassa.

4. The ancient Indian play Mudrarakshasa of Visakhadutt has its subject on:

(a) a conflict between Gods and Demons of ancient Hindu lore.

(b) a romantic story of an Aryan prince and a tribal woman.

(c) the story of the power struggle between two Aryan tribes.

(d) the court intrigues at the time of Chandragupta Maurya.

Ans. (d) : The Mudrarakshasa ("The Signet of the Minister"), a historical play in Sanskrit by Vishakhadatta (4th century CE) narrates the ascent of the king Chandragupta Maurya's power in Northern India. It narrates the court intrigues at the time of Chandragupta Maurya.

5. Who among the following was the first Bhakti saint to use Hindi for the propagation of his message?

(a) Dadu (b) Kabir

(c) Ramananda (d) Tulsidas

Ans. (c) : Ramananda was the first Bhakti saint to use Hindi for the propagation of his message. He was known for communicating in vernacular Hindi, and accepting disciples of all castes.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

6. Assertion (A) : Muhammad bin Tughlaq left Delhi, and, for two years lived in a camp called Swarga-dwari.

Reason (R) : At that time, Delhi was ravaged by a form of plague and many people died.

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true but R is false.

(d) A is false but R is true.

Ans. (a) : Mohammad -bin-Tughlaq was the Sultan of Delhi from 1325 to 1351. From his accession to the throne in 1325 until his death in 1351, Muhammad contended with 22 rebellions, pursuing his policies, consistently and ruthlessly. He left Delhi for two years, lived in a camp called Swarga - dwari. This was because at that time Delhi was ravaged by a form of plague (bubonic) and many people died. It wiped out almost half of Sultan's army. The plague attacked the city in 1334.

7. The historian Barani refused to consider the state in India under Delhi Sultans as truly Islamic because

(a) the majority of the population did not follow Islam.

(b) the Muslim theologists were often disregarded.

(c) the Sultan supplemented the Muslim law by framing his own regulations.

(d) religious freedom was accorded to non-Muslims.

Ans. (a) : The historian Barani did not considered the rule in India under the Sultans of Delhi to be truly Islamic because most of the population of the Sultanate period did not follow Islam.

8. With reference to Sufism in Indian history, consider the following statements:

1. **Shaikh Ahmad Sarhandi was a contemporary of Ibrahim Lodi.**
2. **Shaikh Nasiruddin Chirg-i-Dehlavi was a disciple of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya.**
3. **Aurangzeb was a contemporary of Shaikh Salim Chisti.**
4. **The Qadiri order of Sufis was first introduced in India by Shaikh Niamtullah and Makhdum Muhammad Jilani.**

Which of these statements are correct:

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3

(c) 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

Ans. (d) : Sheikh Ahmad Sarhandi of Naqshbandi order was a contemporary of Akbar and Jahangir. He was disciple of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya. The Qadiri order of Sufis was first introduced in India by Sheikh Nizamatullah (He died in 1430 AD) and Makhdum (or Nasiruddin) Muhammad Jilani (died in 1517).

9. With reference to medieval Indian rulers, which one of the following statements is correct?

(a) Alauddin Khilji first set up a separate ariz's department.

(b) Balban introduced the branding system of horses in his military.

(c) Muhammad bin Tughlaq was succeded by his uncle to the Delhi throne.

(d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq set up a separate department of slaves.

Ans. (d) : Firoz Shah Tughlaq established a seperate department for slaves which was called 'Diwan-i-Bandagan. Muhammad-bin- Tughlaq's cousin Firoz Shah Tughlaq succeeded him to the throne. Alauddin Khilji introduced the branding system of horses in his military. So only option D is correct.

10. The motive behind Shah Jahan's Balkh campaign was to:

(a) Secure a friendly ruler in Balkh and Badakshan which bordered Kabul.

(b) conquer Samarqand and Farghana, the Mughal homelands.

(c) fix the Mughal frontier on the 'scientific line', the Amu Daria.

(d) expand the Mughal Empire beyond the subcontinent.